Q+A

Chicken Soup for the Heart

Former veejay, actor and now travel influencer, **Shenaz Treasury** is out with a book based on past romances–*All He Left Me Was a Recipe*



Q. When did you discover the writer within?

I've been writing since I was a kid. When I had this idea, I actually wanted to make it into a show. But since that's such a process, I reached out to Penguin Random House India for a book, and they loved the idea. I started writing it five years ago but around the same time my travel vlogging really picked up and this got a little sidelined. Then last year, I decided to travel less, write more and complete it, and the book is here!

Q. How much of the story is fact, how much fiction?

I'd love for people to guess... that keeps it spicy! But let's say, there's more fact than fiction. It's about a girl's life from when she's four to 40 and every chapter she's in a different stage of life, with a different guy. So, you see her life journey through the guys she dates.

Q. Who was your favourite character?

I'm dying to make this a show. Every episode will have a different hot guy and, sometimes, one will come back as well! But if I had to pick a favourite, it would be Roller Boy, whom she first meets and dates in 2001 and then he comes back in 2011. He's the 'baddest' boy in the book, the wildest, most loving, passionate and sexy. I like bad boys a lot. Everyone sees me as a good girl...I think good girls like bad boys because they free us from the pressure of being good girls.

Q. Be it relationships or social media, you always put yourself out there. Have present-day trolls ever made you rethink your approach?

I'm just me. At 16, I was doing TV commercials...then I did MTV, then movies in India, then MTV in Asia, then I moved to New York, and I did movies and shows there. You can't be an actor or a TV personality or a social media influencer if you care about what other people think. So, now on social media, I'm just authentically me. And that's not exhausting, it's exhilarating.

–with Priya Pathiyan

Photograph by **HARNESH**; *Styling by* **NIKITA HATEY**